

Gustavo Diaz

Department of Political Science · Northwestern University

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Positions

Northwestern University

Assistant Professor of Instruction, Department of Political Science

2024 -

McMaster University

Postdoctoral Fellow, Department of Political Science

2022 - 2024

Tulane University

Postdoctoral Fellow, Center for Inter-American Policy and Research

2021 - 2022

Education

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

PhD in Political Science

2021

MA in Political Science

2017

Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile

BA in Political Science

2014

Publications

9. Diaz, Gustavo, Jordi Díez, and Michelle L. Dion. Forthcoming. [“Two-Sided Sensitivity Bias in List Experiments: Support for Same-Sex Marriage in Argentina”](#) *Journal of Survey Statistics and Methodology*
8. **Diaz, Gustavo** and Erin Rossiter. 2026. [“Balancing Precision and Retention in Experimental Design.”](#) *Political Analysis* 34 (1): 139-148
7. **Diaz, Gustavo**, Virginia Oliveros, Rebecca Weitz-Shapiro, and Matthew S. Winters. 2025. [“Ignoring Female Performance: A Survey Experiment on Policy Implementation in Argentina.”](#) *British Journal of Political Science* 55: e54
6. **Diaz, Gustavo**. 2024. [“Assessing the Validity of Prevalence Estimates in Double List Experiments.”](#) *Journal of Experimental Political Science* 11(2): 162-174
5. Piazza, Kelly Senters and **Gustavo Diaz**. 2024. [“Data Sources for the Study of Gender and Corruption.”](#) In *Handbook on Gender and Corruption in Democracies*, edited by Emily Beaulieu Bacchus and Tiffany Barnes. Edward Elgar Publishing
4. **Diaz, Gustavo** and Kelly Senters Piazza. 2022. [“Women Held Back: The Depressing Effect of Institutional and Norms-Based Barriers on Female Representation in Corrupt Contexts.”](#) In *Norms, Gender and Corruption: Understanding the Nexus*, edited by Ina Kubbe and Ortrun Merkle. Edward Elgar Publishing
3. Piazza, Kelly Senters and **Gustavo Diaz**. 2020. [“Light in the Midst of Chaos: COVID-19 and Female Political Representation.”](#) *World Development* 136: 105125 (with Kelly Senters Piazza)
2. **Diaz, Gustavo**, Christopher Grady, and James H. Kuklinski. 2020. [“Survey Experiments and the Quest for Valid Interpretation.”](#) In *The SAGE Handbook of Research Methods in Political Science and International Relations*, edited by Luigi Curini and Robert Franzese. London: Sage
1. **Diaz, Gustavo**. 2014. [“Civic Education and Voter Turnout Under Voluntary Voting.”](#) *Política* 52(1): 61-91 (In Spanish)

Under Review

[“Criminal Governance in Unexpected Contexts: the Case of Montevideo, Uruguay”](#) (with Ines Fynn, Verónica Pérez Bentancur, and Lucía Tiscornia)

Revise and resubmit at Latin American Politics and Society

[“Recovering Informative Estimates in Failed Placebo-Controlled List Experiments.”](#) (with Ines Fynn, Verónica Pérez Bentancur, and Lucía Tiscornia)

Under review at Political Analysis

Selected Working Papers

[Difference-in-Slopes: Causal Effects on Descriptive Associations](#) (with Alexander Coppock)

[“Combining List Experiments and the Network Scale-Up Method to Improve Prevalence Estimates of Sensitive Attitudes and Behaviors.”](#) (with Ines Fynn, Verónica Pérez Bentancur, and Lucía Tiscornia)

Teaching

Northwestern University

Survey Research Methods Spring 2027

[Introduction to Empirical Methods in Political Science](#) Spring & Winter 2027, 2026, 2025

[Probability and Statistics \(Graduate\)](#) Fall 2026, 2025, 2024

[Math Camp \(Graduate\)](#) Summer 2026

[Statistical Computing Workshop](#) AY 26-27, 25-26, 24-25

[Machine Learning \(Graduate\)](#) Winter 2026

[Evidence-Informed Decision-Making](#) Spring 2025

McMaster University

[Research Design for Public Opinion and Public Policy](#) Spring 2023-24

Tulane University

[Politics of Developing Democracies](#) Spring 2022

[Comparative Politics](#) Fall 2021

Grants and Awards

2026. European Research Council Starting Grant (co-investigator, ~\$1.5 million USD)

2025-2026. Farrell Fellowship. Northwestern University

2019-2020. Werner Baer Dissertation Writing Fellowship. Lemann Center for Brazilian Studies, University of Illinois

2019. Best Poster Award. Latin American Political Methodology Meeting. Montevideo, Uruguay

2016. Rita and Leonard Ogren Award for Academic Excellence. Department of Political Science, University of Illinois

Selected Talks

2026. [“Recovering Informative Estimates in Failed Placebo-Controlled List Experiments.”](#) University of Chicago

2025. [“Balancing Precision and Retention in Experimental Design.”](#) Texas Methods Meeting

2024. [“The Merits of Externally Invalid Survey Experiments.”](#) MapleMeth

Mentorship

Senior Theses

- Fiona Bolzan (Northwestern, Political Science)
- Elena Mazariegos (Northwestern, International Studies)
- Keeley Sikora (Northwestern, Political Science)
- Inaya Hussain (Northwestern, Mathematical Methods in the Social Sciences)

Service

Reviewer: American Political Science Review, American Journal of Political Science, British Journal of Political Science, Comparative Political Studies, FONDECYT Chile (Political Science), Journal of Elections, Public Opinion and Parties, Public Opinion Quarterly, PS: Political Science

Discussant: MPSA 2021, MPSA 2022, SPSA 2022, APSA 2024, MPSA 2024, MPSA 2025, MPSA 2026, PolMeth 2026

Department

- Member, Comparative politics and data science search committee, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign (2019)
- Coordinator, Statistical Computing Workshop, Northwestern University (2024-)

Discipline

- Chair, Political Methodology section, Midwest Political Science Association, MPSA (2024)

Additional Training

2023. Grant writing workshop for junior faculty. McMaster University

2019. Empirical Implications of Theoretical Models Summer Institute. Emory University

2014. Summer School on Mixed Methods. Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile